

IAN BOOK BELIEVER'S WEEKLY RECAP — YR 4, PLAYOFFS WEEK 2

PRAISE THE FATHER,



THE SON,



& THE HOLY SPIRIT



PLAYOFFS RECAP

SAME STORY, NEW YEAR, JHAJUAN FALLS SHORT IN THE SECOND ROUND

AGAINST BEN 148.65 TO 129.1.

We play the games for a reason. After I crowned Jhajuan as a lock to the title his team shits the bed, and he sits Brock Purdy (41.85), on his way to a loss. Once again, Jhajuan will be playing for third place. A successful season that ended in heartbreaking fashion. And yet it's a first world problem, as some managers still have yet to make the playoffs. Jhajuan will be bringing in the new year by complaining in our groupchat. Chase Brown (32.9), Kyle Pitts (18.7), Devin White (15.75), and Ka'imi Fairbairn (16) couldn't make up for Treyveon Henderson's injury (2.2), or Drake London's (5.7) disappointing game, and ditto for Michael Carter (6.5), Josh Jacobs (4.8) and Nico Collins (9.9).

But enough talk about Jhajuan, Ben's team won and is advancing to his first ever championship appearance. After years of getting finessed, Ben finally broke the barrier. Huge contributions from KW9 (26.9) and James Cook (26.4) helped put Ben over. The Justin Jefferson haul of Jauan Jennings (18.1) and Jaylen Waddle (13.7) was a big help, and that's not even considering Jeanty's 31.8 on the bench. Shout out to Juwan Johnson (16.9) and Tee Higgins (14.3) as well. Ben survived despite bad games from Egbuka (5), Loop (5) and the Seahawks D/St (-4). Congratulations and good luck, Ben.



A clutch game from Kenneth Walker, I told you to trust the vision.

CESAR'S DOMINANT PERFORMANCE AGAINST DAVID M, WINNING 184.5 TO 157.25, SECURES A TITLE SHOT.

This battle of the fighting Irish was over on Thursday night. Puka (46.5) and Stafford (41.5) combined for **82** points... And yet, David M could have won! The points he needed were on his bench. Jaylen Warren (29.1) and QJ (20.4) could've been the difference makers. C'est la vie, David M. Cesar's team was buttressed by a stellar RJ Harvey (22.1) game and solid performances from Mike Evans (14.1) and Justin Jefferson (14.5). Harrison Hitler (11) and Quinshon Judkins (10.1) also contributed. But Judkins is out, and Cesar will have to hope one of the Browns RBs he picked up emerges as the guy. Javonte Williams (6.3), McBride (6.7) and the Chiefs D/ST (1) all attempted to make Cesar stumble. Yet he survived. Congratulations and good luck, Cesar.

David M, meanwhile, suffered a series of disappointments. Jason Myers (2), MHJ (2.4), Tyler Warren (6), Swift (9), Rico (8.3)... a swelling of underperformance. JSN (23.6) could've done better, but give the hero a chance to rest his back. Chase (19.9) had a good game. Gainwell (23.8) has been a late season surprise. Jack Campbell (27.75) dominated once again. Even Drake Maye (29.5) had a great game, but it was too little to overcome Puka and Stafford. David M will be playing for 3rd against Jhajuan to determine how much money the commissioner sends to David M for fantasy dues.



Too many times this picture has been Puka, Stafford or McBride for Cesar. Let's give some respect to the only reliable running back of his, RJ Harvey.

RAPID FIRE RECAP

GEORGE SLAYS THE WHITE DEMON, JOEY, 166.6 TO 149.6, AND STAKES HIS CLAIM AS KING OF SHIT MOUNTAIN.

- Tl;dr: George's team effort was too much for Joey to overcome.
- The hot issue for George is his keeper situation, fortunately for him, his players are showing him they're worth. Fannin (20.25) and Sutton (20.6) are ones to look at.
- At least George will get a chance to meet his average placement of 7th place this year.
- A disappointing end to the season for Joey all around, I had him pegged to compete for the top of the consolation ladder.
- Joey was sold by his reliable hitters, the Sun God (9.4) and Michael Pittman (7.2).

VIC KICKS JOLO BACK DOWN THE LADDER, 154 TO 125.95.

- Tl;dr: Joe Burrow (40.05) showed up this week for Vic.
- Vic has to be a little sad, right? If he was the 6th seed he would've been in the championship this week.
- AJ Brown (18.5), Achane (18), Etienne Jr (16.6) and Blake Cashman (17.25) performed for Vic this week.
- I'm disappointed in you Jolo, I wanted you to go from underdog to king of shit mountain. But that's what you get when you start Mariota (4.65).
- Gibbs (22.8) is like when Chris Paul was on those garbage ass Hornet's teams. Hopefully his excellence isn't wasted on a losing team next year.

DYLAN'S TEAM FORGOT TO GET ON THE BUS, DEJON THRASHES HIS TEAM 131.55 TO 82.

- Tl;dr: Dylan's team scored 82 points man.
- Chris Olave (36.8) has got to be Dejon's keeper, huh? Shough is getting the ball to him, and he's making plays. Could've been a 40 bomb had he caught the TD in the endzone.
- Dejon won't finish in last this year. That's cool. Will he get close to the playoffs next year? Is he figuring it out?
- 82... REALLY?
- Three players scored over or equal to 10: Brock Bowers (14.3), Hurts (25.25), and Zane Gonzalez (10).

DEVON DEFEATS DAVID G IN A MEANINGLESS GAME, 128.85 TO 123.9.

- Tl;dr: Two teams playing for nothing played.

- Another shitty week from Lamar Jackson (5.75), who got injured. A horrible pick in retrospect, but the vision is respected.
- CMC (32.6) and George Pickens (27.5) were the stars of the show this week.
- Funnily enough, the other 2nd round QB, Josh Allen (8.2) also did fuck all this week.
- Besides Bijan (29.8), it was a week led by the Saints D/ST (19) and Cam Little (11) for David G.



Since there's the blank space, let's take some time to appreciate legends of a dying generation of Saints football.



ALL STAR TEAM OF THE WEEK:

Player	Position	Team	FP
Matt Stafford	QB	Cesar	41.45

Run CMC	RB	Devon	32.6
Chase Brown	RB	Jhajuan	32.9
Chris Olave	WR	Dejon	36.8
Puka Nacua	WR	Cesar	46.5
Harold Fannin	TE	George	20.25
Bijan Robinson	FLEX	David G	29.8
George Pickens	FLEX	Devon	27.5
Jack Campbell	IDP	Jolo	27.75
New Orleans	D/ST	David G	19
Ka'imi Fairbairn	K	Jhajuan	16

TOTAL: 330.55 Points

HIGH SCORE: 333.8

AWARDS OF THE WEEK

- MANAGER OF THE WEEK: Ben
- BELT TO ASS AWARD: Dejon, +49.55
 - *Top point differential: Ben, +89.5 – Week 8.*
- UN/LUCKIEST MANAGER OF THE WEEK: Dylan/Ben
- JAUAN JENNINGS AWARD: Charlie Smyth, Joey (...but he didn't play him)
- ISAIAH LIKELY AWARD: Michael Carter, Jhajuan
 - HM: C.J. Stroud, Ben (the *worst* performing QB of the options he had)
- HERO OF THE WEEK: Matthew Stafford and Puka Nacua, Cesar
- MONDAY NIGHT MIRACLE: Ben, Jhajuan benching Purdy for Brissett

MONDAY NIGHT MIRACLE TRACKER:

- Cesar, 1
- Dejon, 2
- Ben, 2
- Jolo, 1

PLAYOFF BRACKET:

#1 London Has Fallen (10-4-0, 1st) BYE	#6 Extra Chromahomes (8-6-0, 6th)148.65 #1 London Has Fallen (10-4-0, 1st)129.1	
#5 Puka Boo (8-6-0, 5th)162.05 #4 Frauds (9-5-0, 4th)144.2		
#6 Extra Chromahomes (8-6-0, 6th)120.6 #3 Strange Things (9-5-0, 3rd)108.8		#6 Extra Chromahomes (8-6-0, 6th)0.0 #5 Puka Boo (8-6-0, 5th)0.0
#2 JSN My Pants (9-5-0, 2nd) BYE	#5 Puka Boo (8-6-0, 5th)184.5 #2 JSN My Pants (9-5-0, 2nd)157.25	

WINNER'S CONSOLATION LADDER

CONSOLATION LADDER:

#8 Scam Little (6-8-0, 8th)171.7 #7 Certified Mid (7-7-0, 7th)142.5 GmC1 - W to GmC4, L to GmC5	#9 Cesar #1 Fan! #1 in my heart! (6-8-0, 9th)166.6 #8 Scam Little (6-8-0, 8th)149.6 GmC4 - W to GmC7, L to GmC8	#9 Cesar #1 Fan! #1 in my heart! (6-8-0, 9th)0.0 #7 Certified Mid (7-7-0, 7th)0.0 GmC7
#10 Team Mickey Mouse (5-9-0, 10th)117.4 #9 Cesar #1 Fan! #1 in my heart! (6-8-0, 9th)141.85 GmC2 - W to GmC4, L to GmC6	#12 Maybe Next Year (3-11-0, 12th)125.95 #7 Certified Mid (7-7-0, 7th)154.0 GmC5 - W to GmC7, L to GmC9	#11 Sorry This Had 2 Happen 2 U (4-10-0, 11th)0.0 #8 Scam Little (6-8-0, 8th)0.0 GmC8
#12 Maybe Next Year (3-11-0, 12th)149.1 #11 Sorry This Had 2 Happen 2 U (4-10-0, 11th)137.35 GmC3 - W to GmC5, L to GmC6	#11 Sorry This Had 2 Happen 2 U (4-10-0, 11th)131.55 #10 Team Mickey Mouse (5-9-0, 10th)82.0 GmC6 - W to GmC8, L to GmC9	#12 Maybe Next Year (3-11-0, 12th)0.0 #10 Team Mickey Mouse (5-9-0, 10th)0.0 GmC9

END OF SEASON POWER RANKINGS

Team	Record	Weekl y Record	Point s For	Points Against	Stand ing	3 Week	Rank	Power Rank	Chan ge	Power Score	Luck Score	Adjusted
Jhajuan	10 - 4	115-39	2196.85	2103.85	1	3.00	1	1	-	186.73	-2.53	189.26
David M	9 - 5	103-51	2168.60	1965.90	2	2.00	2	2	-	182.37	-6.62	189.00
Cesar	8 - 6	90-64	2091.30	1920.05	5	1.00	5	3	▲ 3	171.75	4.16	167.60
Ben	8 - 6	100-54	2083.30	1962.50	6	6.00	6	4	▲ 1	170.44	-3.51	173.95
David G	9 - 5	68-86	1940.65	1891.50	4	8.00	4	5	▼ 1	169.55	11.17	158.38
Devon	9 - 5	82-72	2000.15	1848.85	3	12.00	3	6	▼ 3	168.85	9.35	159.49
Vic	7 - 7	75-79	2004.05	1929.85	7	4.00	7	7	▲ 1	164.23	-5.13	169.36
Joey	6 - 8	98-56	1967.35	2045.60	8	9.00	8	8	▼ 1	161.07	0.00	161.07
George	6 - 8	68-86	1924.10	2023.65	9	7.00	9	9	-	156.18	-5.58	161.77
Dylan	5 - 9	52-102	1842.10	1945.80	10	10.00	10	10	-	146.60	6.62	139.98
Jolo	3 - 11	50-104	1811.30	2106.05	12	11.00	12	11	-	137.76	-6.75	144.51
Dejon	4 - 10	73-81	1764.45	2050.60	11	5.00	11	12	-	135.19	5.26	129.93

[*Formula courtesy some Redditors who like fantasy football.*](#)

Note: Power Rankings are only for the regular season

WEEKLY MATCHUP PREVIEW AND PREDICTIONS

CHAMPIONSHIP MATCH: Ben v. Cesar

- Finally! A new champion will be crowned. It's fitting that these two teams made such a major trade, and yet, the center piece, Justin Jefferson, isn't even in play for Cesar. Will Ben defeat the goliath of the Stafford-Puka stack and Trey McBride with the depth he traded for? Unfortunately, I don't think so. I'm predicting that **Cesar** will be our newest champion of the Ian Book Believers. Ben's had a great season that started hot and ended skirting into the playoffs to make a championship run, but it's hard to beat the 50 to 70 points a week from 2 players that Cesar's been getting on his own run.

THIRD PLACE MATCH: David M v. Jhajuan

- Seemingly, Jhajuan's team is falling apart (again) in the playoffs. David M's team always looks great on paper, but paper is different then game day. Assuming both teams are mostly healthy, give me **Jhajuan** to finish third.

FIFTH PLACE MATCH: David G v. Devon

- I don't think either team cares about who wins, it's projected to be close. I'll pick **Devon** this week, since I picked David G last week.

SEVENTH PLACE MATCH: George v. Vic

- Vic's team was one of the hottest ending the season, but George's team has performed in the consolation ladder. My gut tells me **Vic**.

NINTH PLACE MATCH: Dejon v. Joey

- Last year, Dejon finished dead last. This is a massive improvement whether he wins or loses. I'm picking **Joey**, solely because the black magic hasn't happened yet.

ELEVENTH PLACE MATCH: Jolo v. Dylan

- First off, I'm surprised I spelled "11th" correctly. Second, I don't really gaf about this game, but Jolo is projected to win *without a QB*, so I'm gonna pick **Jolo**. Sorry Dylan.

COMMISH PICK'EM'S RECORD:

19-15

- Last week's picks:
 - I'm an idiot → Jhajuan; David G; Joey; Jolo (sorry, cursed)
 - Called it → Cesar; Dejon (you're welcome)